

DEBUNKING DATA SHARING MYTHS

Myth #1: Data protection laws prohibits organisations from sharing data.

Fact: Data protection supports the legal, ethical, and equitable sharing of data and not opposed to sharing of data. Personal identifiable information should be omitted or pseudonymised before data is shared and ethical approvals from ethics committees are required in most cases

Myth #2: When I share my data, I would lose ownership of the data and the data can be accessed directly by anyone globally.

Fact: Under a managed/controlled access governance framework, data is submitted for sharing with a Terms of submissions agreement which clearly gives you ownership of the data. Access to the data is governed by applications to a Data Access Committee or a similar governing body that approves/rejects or asks for more information based on certain data access guidelines

Myth #3: Data sharing benefits the repository in which data is deposited only and not the interest of the researcher(s) sharing the data.

Fact: When you share your data, you are helping to create innovation, increase scientific discoveries, improving health, and saving lives. Your data becomes a public good which can be pooled with other data for secondary analyses to answer more research questions. Access to this data is obtained with applications

to a Data Access Committee and a data object identifier (DOI) is minted to your data so that whenever it is used, it gives you academic credit. The more your data is used, the more citations and hence academic credits you obtain.

FOLLOW US

Are you ready to unlock the power of data driven healthcare? Join our platform today and gain access to a wealth of health data. Contact us to learn more and start your journey towards more impactful and innovative research.

Visit us at <https://www.hdrwa.org> to learn more about how you can contribute to scientific knowledge and improving healthcare by sharing your data securely with us and meeting all privacy guidelines. You will also learn how to benefit from using other researchers' data by going through our applications for data request.



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HDRWA
Health Data Research West Africa

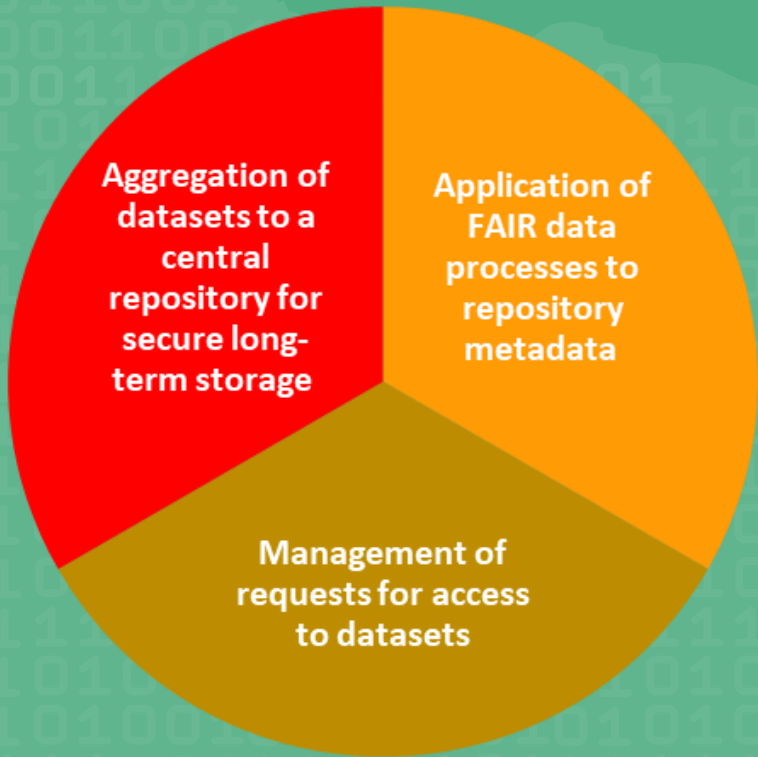
WANETAM DATA SHARING PLATFORM

INTRODUCTION

Scientific research relies on the accumulation and dissemination of data to advance knowledge. However, despite the growing recognition of the importance of data sharing, many scientists are still hesitant to share their research data. Understanding the reasons behind scientists' reticence to share data is crucial for promoting a culture of collaboration and for advancing scientific knowledge in a transparent and collaborative manner.

ABOUT HDRWA

Health Data Research West Africa (HDRWA) is a data sharing platform established by WANETAM with a data repository and a governance framework to develop and enable the generation of new scientific evidence through sharing of various clinical research data including TB, HIV, Malaria, Re-emerging Infections as well as Noncommunicable diseases (NCDs). The Platform fulfils three distinct purposes as depicted in the following graph:



GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

Our platform's governance structure ensures that your data is handled with the utmost care. It is composed of a Steering Committee, a Data Access Committee and a Secretariat. **The Steering Committee** provides input on strategic direction of the Platform. It also provides advice and support to the HDRWA Secretariat on matters of governance, operations, and Data Access Committee activity. **The Data Access Committee** reviews and approves all data access applications and ensure they are in accordance with our guidelines for data access. **The Secretariat** manages day-to-day operations and communications between all relevant stakeholders.

DATA PRIVACY AND PROTECTION POLICY

We take data privacy and security seriously. We only collect, use and share health research data that has scientific validity and obtained with consent from individuals who participated in the studies. Before sharing, we go through a process of pseudonymisation to remove all Personally Identifiable Information (PII). We then store the data securely on our servers and access to the data is obtained through the submission of an application for access made to the Data Access Committee in accordance with our platforms' data access guidelines. We transfer data only through secure channels and encrypt it during transit and at rest. We also ensure that data recipients understand their obligations and responsibilities through a Data Use Agreement. Our platform complies with relevant laws and regulations, including GDPR, and follows best practices and standards of data privacy and security in handling health research data. For more information on our data privacy and policy, please visit: <https://www.hdrwa.org>

